



Ceres and District Community Council
Minutes of the Meeting Monday 12 September 2022
Craigrothie Village Hall

Present: Moira Henderson (Chair), David Beveridge, Christine Hudson, Faith Nicholson, John Hudson, Cllr Stefan Hoggan-Radu, Cllr John Caffrey and four members of the public

Zoom: Alistair Ewan, Amy Ross-Henderson

Apologies: John Borland, Cllr Margaret Kennedy and two members of the public.

1. **Welcome:** Moira Henderson (Chair) welcomed all attendees, both in the hall and on Zoom, to the public meeting.
2. **Queen Elizabeth II:** The Chair commenced the proceeding by acknowledging the death of Her Majesty Queen Elizabeth II and read a memorial statement on behalf Ceres and District Community Council. The Chair's statement summarised the Queen's lifetime of service, including some illustrative insights and a testimony that Her Majesty undoubtedly fulfilled her succession vow of allegiance. The Chair offered condolences on behalf of our community.
3. **Previous Meeting Minutes:** The minutes for the previous meeting on 11 July 2022 are confirmed as formally approved by the Community Council and are available to the public.
4. **Ceres Traffic Consultation:** The Community Council reported an update from Cllr Margaret Kennedy, relating to the email received from Lesley Craig, which stated "The raised table notice went live on 5th August and closes for objections on 2nd September - should be on site at the location. The 20mph notices are already on site too - going live tomorrow with a closing date of 16th September. After those dates, as long as we do not get any objections, we can progress to implementing it on the ground. We just have to get it in the Construction team's programme, which they won't do until we are clear of the objection period."

Other traffic calming measures, in particular relating to the burn bridge on the B939 remain pending and there is no known timeline for progress. Cllr Kennedy offered to contact Lesley Craig regarding progress.

5. **Other Traffic Matters:**

Problems with Speeding, accident / near miss blackspots, dangerous cornering, antisocial parking have been reported to Fife Police and we now have a detailed response. This is appended at the end of the minutes, for public reference.

It was reported that on 23 August 2022 the A939 was blocked for a few hours due to a serious van crash near Baltilly Farm. This is considered to be an indication that the 60mph speed limit on this road is too high.

The Community Council has had a complaint from a Ceres resident that traffic regularly exceeds the 20mph speed limit entering Ceres on the Cupar Road at Bridgend. There is traffic reducing box-outs at the Ceres boundary but this is not 100% effective. It may help if Pop-up-Bob could be deployed there, and the secretary will write to the Fife Police Community Officer with a request.

There have been further comments from a number of Craigrothie residents regarding excessive speeding through the village on both Cupar Road and Ceres Road. Drivers approach the village at up to 60mph or over and continue through the village at speeds over 30mph because there are no speed reducing measures at all three entry points to the village. The junction at Craigrothie Village Hall is a persistent problem, with too many vehicles completely cutting the corner. Cllr John Caffrey suggested that speed monitors could be deployed by Fife Council and he will approach Lesley Craig to see if this is possible. Cllr Stefan Hoggan-Radu commented that Dairsie CC had achieved something similar and that he would approach them for further information.

A member of the public requested that C&DCC now take formal action on the previously raised complaint about the exit from the Spar shop car park in Ceres, as the Ceres Traffic Consultation is at a conclusion. Opinions at the meeting were mixed and, although visibility is often obstructed due to parked vehicles, traffic on Main Street is generally slow and leaving the car park may simply require normal care and attention. The proposed solution of double yellow lines either side of the entrance was questioned. It was suggested that double yellow lines outside the shops may only result in parking on the opposite side, which would exacerbate the problem. Also, this would probably be opposed by the Spar and Ceres Butcher shops. It was commented that extensive double yellow lines would be generally unpopular in Ceres, because of residential parking needs on Main Street. It was also commented that restricting parking on Main Street may result in increased traffic speeds, which is not desirable. It was commented that this is an isolated relatively minor local problem and not a major or extensive issue. Considering the scale of the problem and because opinion was clearly divided it was concluded that C&DCC would monitor the situation but take no action at this stage.

6. **Ceres & District Community Trust Update**

- **The Glebe:** As stated at the July meeting the Glebe project is on hold until the Church of Scotland is in a position to fully understand the future of local churches. A full Glebe business plan was submitted to the Church by the Ceres & District Trust some months ago which could be a joint Trust/Church project if required.
- **Burn Walls:** Significant funds are required to complete the building of the burn wall along the Ceres Green. £60,000 has been spent by Fife Council on the walls so far. There is £30-40,000 potentially earmarked from Fife Council but another £100,000 is likely to be required on top of this to complete the operations. The Trust are applying to Fife Environmental Trust for the maximum grant of around £40,000.
- **New Gate from Wemysshall Road to Tarvit Mansion Grounds:** Alistair Ewan had a meeting with Chris Smith (Lead Planning Officer - Fife Council) on 30 August. Fife Council had considered refusing planning due to the possibility of the ancient wall being damaged. Cllr Margaret Kennedy managed to get Chris Smith to enter talks between National Trust and Ceres & District Community Trust. Following verbal and written justification on road safety and the beneficial links to Craigrothie and the Pilgrims Way, Mr Smith agreed a recommendation of permission be given. The community gate installation proposal was to carefully cut an opening in the wall and install a self-closing metal gate, which requires no maintenance. This could be undertaken by Trust volunteers at low cost. Fife Council, supported by the NTS, now want the wall taken down by hand with no stone cutting. The gate must be a wooden gate with spring closure mounted on wooden straining posts. The wall must have no cut stones and be re-erected utilising lime mortar. This work will need to be by professional tradesmen costing several thousand of pound rather than hundreds. Also, National Trust Scotland will only take an overseeing role and not

provide any financial input, so all costs must be met by the and Ceres & District Community Trust and/or any public donations. Cllr John Caffrey confirmed that Cllr Margaret Kennedy would continue pursuing this.

- **Craigrothie to Denhead Footpath:** The spring in the middle of the path will be sorted, the aim is to pipe the water into the adjacent field and the water will find its way to the burn. DT Stewart are quoting to undertake repairs.
- **Ceres Toilets:** The toilets are in a state of disrepair and require a massive overhaul or rebuilding. It has been suggested funding “may” be available. This project requires significant consideration as any project should consider what retail unit could be linked allowing toilet management. It was pointed out that this had been considered previously with a view to linking the toilet provision to the Spar shop, Village Café of Folk Museum, but that these had not been found to be financially viable. Cllr John Caffrey commented that he is currently looking into a similar situation with Geoff Jacobs in Cupar, and he offered to make enquiries.
- **Moor Road Footpath:** Sustainable Cupar had originally installed the footpath but work by SGN has resulted in the path being washed into the adjoining ditch. As the path sits on top of the gas pipeline, only SGN can carry out the necessary repair work. Following a request by Cllr Margaret Kennedy and significant community communication, SGN have finally committed to meet with Ceres Trust to discuss the solution. This has yet to be arranged but anticipated week ending 17 September.
- **Pilgrim Way – Wheelchair Accessibility:** The proposal to create wheelchair accessibility on the Struthers Barns to Ceres section of the Pilgrim Way was mentioned but the cost of this would be high and extremely difficult to fund in the current economic climate.
- **Ceres Community Trust AGM:** It is planned to hold a public AGM in November at which time the Community will be invited to discuss their views future projects.

7. Status of Grit Bin Removal from North Croftdyke

- Cllr Margaret Kennedy has reported an update from Bill Liddle (Fife Council) – “All grit bins will be refilled prior to winter and we will return (or move) any outstanding grit bin requests at this time. This will start around October and will last for 5/6 weeks.”

8. Local Authority Planning Applications

- Proposed housing development at Baltilly: No further planning development, as yet. In the event of future applications C&DCC will apply to be a Statutory Consultee in order to best represent the community. It was pointed out that the approval to date does require the development to provide additional safe footpath access to the village, which had been an earlier public concern.
- On 13 July C&DCC received a query from Fiona Bennett / Wendy Chamberlain MP regarding two planning applications at Teasses Mill, Ceres. After fully researching the cases C&DCC responded in detail on 21 July 2022 but have not received any response except for a standard autoreply. Cllr John Caffrey asked if C&DCC required any follow up and it was confirmed that, in the absence of further correspondence, C&DCC now considered the matter closed.
- There was a comment regarding the time taken for planning approval by Fife Council. The case of a glamping pod application at Gladney was quoted as taking a particularly long time.

9. Craigrothie Bus Shelter Storm Blown into Adjacent Field

- C&DCC have provided Fife Council with options and local preferences. The response and any action are still pending. Cllr John Caffrey offered to follow up, together with Cllr Margaret Kennedy.

10. Police Report

- Summary of police report. The Chair commented that the monthly police report had not been received, adding that to date the information had been poor. Cllr John Caffrey confirmed that adequate police reporting is also a problem for Fife Council but that he would chase up the report for the next meeting.
- Other policing issues: Cllr John Caffrey informed that the new Community Police Officer for the area is PC Lee Smith.
- There has been no recent recurrence of anti-social behaviour except for littering on Bow Butts.

11. Local Road Maintenance Works

- The CC noted that the Fife Council website <https://www.fife.gov.uk/> has a facility for reporting on maintenance problems. This is effective and is relatively easy to use.
- The reported potholes adjacent to bridge in Ceres were noted and, although some work has been done, some of it may only be temporary. The CC will monitor the status.

12. Resilience Group

- Cllr Margaret Kennedy has informed C&DCC: "Hoping that the CC is aware of the work being carried out by the new Minister in relation to Place of Warmth. Fife Council is seeking to provide central support within communities ahead of the winter with all the concerns around the cost of living." The Chair is also hoping to meet with the new Minister to discuss this and Poverty Groups.
- Cllr Stefan Hoggan-Radu commented that the Place of Warmth initiative is still in its infancy but that he will keep the CC updated. Faith Nicholson enquired whether grant support is available and this was confirmed.

13. Fireworks

- Because opinion is split & funding a problem C&DCC cannot manage the event.

14. Annual Community Bus Trip

- Because the Covid numbers are remaining high it is considered that the bus trip would be too great a risk at this time. However, it was suggested that the possibility should be reconsidered in spring 2023.

15. Proposals to Regenerate St Andrews Community Hospital

- There is a call for Community Councils to support the reconstitution of the public initiative for the regeneration and expansion of St Andrews Community Hospital. It was universally agreed that the CC should fully support this.

16. Christmas Lights

- The return of "Wonky Christmas Lights" in Newburgh has prompted a resident to request if this could be a consideration for our district. Whilst the idea was considered good in principle, the logistics and financing were generally considered to be outside the feasibility of the CC.

17. Community Council Vacancies

- Two community councillors are still required to fill the vacancies.

18. Any Other Business

- **Local Place Plans:** The CC noted the introduction of Local Place Plans. This is an initiative by the Scottish Government. Local Place Plans have been introduced to encourage communities to be active participants in planning for their futures. These are plans for local communities that have a focus on development, land use and 'place-making' (an all-inclusive approach to the design, development, regeneration and management of the built environment). Fife Council will keep a register of Local Place Plans as they are prepared in Fife and make information about them available so that people can see if there is a Local Place Plan in their area.

Fife Council are currently inviting communities to create Local Place Plans and have information available, including the "Is a LPP Right for Your Community" page. This could assist us decide whether a Local Place Plan is right for our community and what alternative options we might want to consider instead.

It was noted that should we decide to set up a Local Place Plan we would require the cooperation of our elected councillors. We have been contacted by neighbouring CC's with a view to initiate joint LPP's that would have a cohesive and co-ordinated impact. Whilst this could be beneficial, it is commented that there is also the possibility that there could be conflicting interests between different CC areas and even within our own district.

However, the CC advised that there are potential cost impacts involved, noting that some similar initiatives in other areas in Scotland have involved almost full-time professional involvement and have cost significant sums of money. A comment from a member of the public was that it does appear that the initiative would involve a considerable amount of work.

Currently the CC remains positive, whilst seeking further information and monitoring developments. We are continuing to review the requirements, potential benefits, costs, etc.

- **Quiz Night:** The forthcoming quiz night on 30 September in support of Ceres Memorial Hall was noted and CC members encouraged to attend. the Quiz night proceeds will also be split with "Friends of The Rings".

Other Traffic Matters (Item 5 Above)

Official Response from PC Duncan Shand, Cupar Community Ward Officer

Margaret, John,

Please see our response to the questions raised by John Hudson (Ceres & District Community Council)

1. Regarding matters of speeding on the A916 between Kennoway and Craigrothie. - This is a national speed limit we are not authorised on health and safety to use the Speed gun on these sections of the road. We have referred your issues to Fife Camera Safety Unit. I have also had a complaint from a local resident and there has been stop point placed in the area of Struthers Barns.
2. A916 Craigrothie Primary School - PC's Fergusson and Shand have over recent months attended on numerous occasions to this location, both in the times before and after school when the 20mph lights have been active. A number of vehicles have been stopped regarding speed where verbal warning and tickets have been issued. Pop up bob has also been located on several occasions in this area.
3. B939 Craigrothie - The speed gun has been deployed at this location and Pop up Bob placed on a number of occasions
4. B939 Ceres - We regularly attend at Ceres Primary School where the Speed gun has been deployed. A number of vehicles have been stopped and warnings given due to speeding. However, no tickets have been issued. We have seen the benefit of the speed bump at the zebra crossing at the Anstruther Road junction.
5. Wemysshall Road, Ceres - This is the first complaint regarding speeding we have received for this area and we will factor this into our deployments with Pop up Bob being deployed in the area.
6. Craigrothie Junction and bad bend at Old Kingarroch - This is a road construction / Council matter.

However, when Police are in the area and observe any issues relating to careless or dangerous driving this would be dealt with. It has been noted that at the corner at Old Kingarroch the pavement and fence show no signs of recent damage. Further to this we have check police systems and there has been no reported RTC's to police in the last 24 months (July 2020 – July 2022) at either location.

The number 1 concern that is raised time and time again throughout all of the Community Councils areas of the Cupar Ward is speeding. Whenever possibly dependant on operational policing deployments the local community and response teams will attend areas with the Unipar and target speeding and as well as placing Pop up Bob.

Further to this the Community Speed Watch is beginning to be reactivated after Covid and we are actively looking for volunteers who will require to be vetted and trained to assist the police to promote safer driving in the area.

I hope this answers the queries raised and we continue to promote safe and responsible driving throughout the area.

Regards

Duncan